



sung. Although the folks at Samsung wanted Alok Nath to come over to Korea and work with them from their headquarters, Alok Nath's priority was now sorted out; he could not leave his family in India and the family was not in a position to relocate at that juncture.

So, Alok Nath was almost ready to decline the offer but his destiny, however, had other plans. The very next day after this interview, he received a call from Samsung HQ. "They were willing to interview me again to create a position especially for me if I only wanted to work in India."

This is how Alok Nath became the first CTO of the Indian unit of the conglomerate with his base in Bangalore. His mantra, again, was simple—he didn't want to work on something that was going well. He wanted something that was aspirational, but they couldn't seem to make it work.

At Samsung, he had to create an innovation layer onto the flagship products by building new intellectual properties (IPs) without jeopardising base engineering deliveries. In the first fifteen years of Samsung's journey in India, it had about 2000 patents, which increased to 7500+ patents under his leadership by their silver jubilee celebrations time.

He became the Corporate VP for Samsung Electronics, Korea and contributed to the internet of things (IoT) on SmartThings platform. Despite these accomplishments, he felt like something was missing. The earlier-missed opportunity to join the team in Korea kept gnawing at him. He asked them if he could join them in HQ and the team in Korea happily agreed. He got an IoT lab to work in Korea where he spent 7-8 days every month for thirty months or so. This made him a very effective global leader.

The data platform that Alok Nath built in Korea is now connecting 200 million home appliances and mobile devices globally. With his global

## Some Unknown Facts about Dr Alok Nath De

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|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| • <b>Favourite cuisine</b>     | : Hyderabad Biryani                             |
| • <b>Favourite book(s)</b>     | : Isaac Asimov (Robot Dreams, Fantastic Voyage) |
| • <b>Favourite leader</b>      | : Swami Vivekananda                             |
| • <b>Favourite film</b>        | : Three Idiots                                  |
| • <b>Favourite actor</b>       | : Nasiruddin Shah                               |
| • <b>Favourite actress</b>     | : Smita Patil                                   |
| • <b>Favourite sports</b>      | : Volleyball                                    |
| • <b>Favourite music genre</b> | : Classical                                     |
| • <b>Car and bike</b>          | : Black Car                                     |

role and expertise in AI and Blockchain, he has built an impactful AIoT Centre-of-Excellence in India. Now, with this background and experience behind him, he has set a personal mission of researching and nurturing activities around Cyber-Physical Systems.

### Finding love, fitness goals, and his mission

While the accomplishments of Alok Nath are innumerable, his story of finding his love is like a romantic film. Alok Nath and his wife knew each other since long, but never knew that they would be cojoined by destiny in an everlasting bond.

They got married towards the end of Alok Nath's PhD, that is, six months before he would graduate. His wife had to stay back in Kolkata for some time. "She had to go to a neighbour's place to call me and had to request them to go out," he laughs. She soon joined him in Canada, where she also pursued a postgraduate degree at Concordia University.

Upon returning to India, she has been working as a Math teacher. She is a big fitness junkie.

"She is also my personal trainer. I was never into fitness that much, but since the pandemic, I started taking care of my physique. And would it not be a waste if I didn't utilise my opportunity despite having a trainer at home!" he says with a smile.

The couple has a son who was born in Canada, studied in India,

and went on to pursue Economics and Physics at the University of Chicago. After his stint at an investment bank, he currently works with a global new-gen ride-sharing company.

Alok Nath's love for music is still intact, thanks to his mother who continues to practice music till date. She is the inspiration behind his love for classical music.

In December 2021, Alok Nath took superannuation from Samsung formally. However, he is still associated with them as an Executive Consulting Director and wishes to continue as long as it makes sense for both. He calls it his Corporate Home.

Alok Nath has increased his efforts to mentor deep-tech startups and has also become an angel investor. He is now an Adjunct Professor with IISc (ECE) and IIT Jodhpur (CS). Alok Nath also has a venture of his own in the works.

Talking of his future plans, Alok Nath says, "During India's 75th Independence Day celebration, it is solemn for me to rededicate to the service of the nation. R&D serves as an impetus for business growth. If we can hone India's talent for R&D and can excite business to spend greater on R&D and innovation, we can do wonders as a country."

In fact, he revealed that the unveiling of his singular mission could happen soon; but he is in no hurry. Because if there's anything he has learnt, it is to make 'the rest of his life, the best of his life!' **EFY**